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‘You would do anything to protect your kids’

New England camps assess protocols for safety after Texas flooding disaster

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

Behind the swimming, sailing, archery, and sing-alongs that make up summer camp, the staff who supervise thousands of children at idyllic locales throughout New England have been reminded by the Texas flooding tragedy that safety underlies all the fun and games. “When you’re a camp director, you would do anything to protect your children, to protect your kids. I

can only imagine what those camp directors were going through at that time,” said Susan Hild, the third-generation director of Camp Merriwood in Orford, N.H.

Flash flooding has killed more than 100 people in Texas since Friday, including dozens of campers and staff members at the all-girls Camp Mystic, on the Guadalupe River. The disaster has underscored the critical importance of checking and re-checking safety protocols, said

Hild, who also is president of the New Hampshire Camp Directors Association.

“We intentionally avoid pitching tents or putting cabins near riverbanks or low-lying wash areas” at Camp Merriwood, which was founded in 1949 and serves girls from 8 to 15 years old, Hild said.

“We know where those flash-points are, and camp activities are well away from those areas for a reason,” she added.

Radios are tuned to the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration for alerts. Walkie-talkies are supplied to staff to communicate

An awful toll

Officials said the number of dead from the Texas flooding topped 100, including 27 from a girls’ camp. **A6.**

with each other if bad weather is spotted near the camp on Upper Baker Pond. And emergency response plans are pre-arranged with local authorities.

“Our camp takes a proactive, multifaceted approach to camper safety. We’re continuously monitor-

CAMPS, Page A6

RFK Jr’s policy on vaccines targeted

Health groups sue over new recommendations, dismissal of expert panel

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

A coalition of leading Massachusetts and national health organizations sued Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. Monday, for “arbitrarily and capriciously” **►Measles cases in the nation are at a 33-year high. A2.**

s c r a p p i n g COVID-19 vaccination recommendations for children and pregnant women and for dismantling an influential expert panel that advises the government on immunizations.

The coalition filed the suit in US District Court in Massachusetts to “defend vaccine policy, and to put an end to the Secretary’s assault on science, public health and evidence-based medicine.”

The lawsuit asks for preliminary and permanent injunctions to prohibit Kennedy’s cancellation of COVID vaccine recommendations and a declaratory judgment pronouncing the change in recommendations as unlawful.

“This administration is an existential threat to vaccination in America, and those in charge are only just getting started,” Richard H. Hughes IV, lead attorney for the plaintiffs, said in a briefing with reporters. “If left unchecked, Secretary Kennedy will accomplish his goal of ridding the Unit-

LAWSUIT, Page A7

Frozen funds imperil help for needy students

US withholding of \$108m from Mass. would curtail afterschool programs

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

Thousands of Massachusetts students are at risk of losing needed services and afterschool enrichment opportunities this fall after the Trump administration withheld \$108 million in appropriated federal funding.

That money was part of \$6 billion the Department of Education last week unexpectedly withheld from states across the country for services including English learner education, teacher training, and out-of-school programs.

If the Trump administration does not reverse course, Andrew O’Leary, superintendent of New Bedford Public Schools, said his district will have to phase out a popular afterschool program that has been offered for two decades. He said he intends, however, to maintain core English language services no matter what.

“These funds go to the neediest students, **SUMMER SCHOOL, Page A7**

CAST IN THE GLOW OF SUMMER



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

STAN GROSSFELD
AS I SEE IT

The season — its warmth, joys, freedoms — can pass quickly. Time can seem to dawdle a bit, however, if moments such as the afterglow of a sunset behind the Bunker Hill Monument can be savored. **B1.**

Four defendants who had been held on bail in Boston were ordered released amid the ongoing work stoppage by court-appointed attorneys. **B1.**

Chinatown has some new neighbors: international restaurant chains. Shirley Leung takes a look at what that could mean for the mom-and-pop restaurants that have thrived there for generations. **D1.**

Boston University announced \$50 million in budget cuts and layoffs of 120 staff members, the latest fallout from the Trump administration’s freezes and rescissions on funding. **D1.**

President intensifies trade skirmish with allies Japan, S.Korea, and others

By Ana Swanson and Tony Romm
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump revived his trade war threat with more than a dozen countries on Monday, telling them they would face double-digit tariff rates on their exports as of Aug. 1 unless they agree to trade deals by then. The president targeted two of America’s closest foreign allies, Japan and South Korea, as well as Thailand, Indonesia, South Africa, and Bosnia-Herzegovina.

In addition, administration officials said that they would extend the timeline for dozens of other countries

to sign deals with the United States or face tariffs and that Trump was preparing to sign an executive order to delay the stiff levies that were supposed to snap back on Wednesday.

Markets dropped after the news, as investors assessed the prospect of more trade conflict with some of America’s closest allies and largest trading partners. The S&P 500 ended Monday down 0.8 percent. Other major indexes also fell.

In nearly identical letters to the president of South Korea and the prime minister of Japan, Trump wrote that the countries would face a 25 percent tax on their exports next

month, adding, “we have decided to move forward with you, but only with more balanced, and fair, TRADE.”

“Please understand that the 25% number is far less than what is needed to eliminate the Trade Deficit disparity we have with your Country,” he wrote.

A few hours later, Trump posted several more letters to social media detailing tariff rates that products from other foreign countries would face: 40 percent for exports from Myanmar and Laos, 30 percent for exports from South Africa, and 25 percent for Malaysia. He quickly fol-

TARIFFS, Page A7

Region experiences one of its worst tick seasons

By Angela Mathew
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Lynne McCormack moved to Chilmark last year and enjoys working at the public library in the small town on Martha’s Vineyard. But this summer, McCormack, an avid hiker, said she’s afraid to explore the trails near her house.

“My partner has lived here since the 1970s, and this is the worst tick season he’s ever seen,” McCormack said.

McCormack finds ticks on her body every time she comes inside from the garden, despite wearing insect repellent clothing and spraying cedar oil on her lawn. Her partner, like many on Martha’s Vineyard, suffers from

Alpha-gal syndrome, an allergy to red meat and dairy products triggered by the bite of a Lone Star tick.

New Englanders are used to dealing with a vast assortment of ticks, including Lone Star ticks, deer ticks that carry Lyme disease, and American dog ticks that can transmit Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever. But this season is shaping up to be a particularly bad one, with a surge of tick-borne diseases and tick exposures across the country, especially in the Northeast.

In June, visits to emergency rooms for tick bites reached their highest levels in at least five years in New England and

TICKS, Page A10



DAVID L RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF

233 out of 100,000 ER visits in the Northeast last month were for tick bites, nearly double the national average of 118.

Kevin, a golden retriever, waited for water in his Topsfield pool with Lily Marvin. Kevin had Lyme disease from a tick bite.



It’s stick season

Tuesday: Humid and stormy. High 88-93, low 65-70.

Wednesday: Much cooler. High 71-76, low 62-67.

Sunrise: 5:15. Sunset: 8:23. Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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